BUILDING PERFORMANCE

E1 Surface water

Disposal of rainwater from external surfaces and confirmation surface water cannot enter the building.

This clause requires buildings and site work to be constructed to protect people and other property from the adverse effects of surface water.

It sets out performance requirements to ensure drainage systems are in place for the disposal of surface water using gravity where possible, and to avoid blockages and leakage.

Record of amendments (https://www.building.govt.nz/building-code-compliance/how-the-building-code-works/different-ways-to-comply/acceptable-solutions-and-verification-methods/record-of-amendments)
is a record of changes to the acceptable solutions, verification methods and handbooks.

Building Code Regulations

The Building Code is published in Schedule 1

of the Building Regulations 1992.

The Building Code clauses include objectives, functional requirements and performance criteria. These are mandatory provisions that all new building work must comply with.

The acceptable solutions and verification methods provided on this page are deemed to comply with Building Code clause E1.

Clause E1 — Surface water

Read clause E1 of the Building Code
https://www.legislation.govt.nz/regulati

Updates

New Building Code documents published on 2 November 2023

2 NOVEMBER 2023

MBIE has published Building Code updates on plumbing and drainage, protection from fire and structural stability of hollow-core floors.

(https://www.building.govt.nz/about-building-performance/all-news-and-updates/updates-to-the-building-code-have-been-published)

View all related news and updates (https://www.building.govt.nz/search?bcc%5B%5D=e1-surface-water&area=news-and-updates&show=all&action_doSearch=Search&sort=recent#results)

Acceptable Solutions and Verification Methods

Current version

MBIE has historical versions of the code clause documents which can be located under 'Previous Versions' and 'Version History'. Alternatively if you cannot find the document you are looking for, you can send an email with the year and code clause you are after to info@building.govt.nz.

1st edition, amendment 12

[PDF 2.7 MB]

Effective on 2 November 2023

(https://www.building.govt.nz/assets/Uploads/building-code-compliance/e-moisture/e1-surface-water/asvm/e1-surface-water-1st-edition-amendment-12.pdf)

Previous versions

1st edition, amendment 11

[PDF 1.9 MB]

(https://www.building.govt.nz/assets/Uploa
code-compliance/e-moisture/e1-surface-water/asvm/e1-surface-water-1st-edition-amendment11.pdf)

1st edition, amendment 11 replacement pages

[PDF 1.1 MB]

(https://www.building.govt.nz/assets/Upl
code-compliance/e-moisture/e1-surface
water/asvm/e1-surface-water-1st-editior
amendment11-rp.pdf)

1st edition, amendment 10

[PDF 2.5 MB]

(https://www.building.govt.nz/assets/Uploa
code-compliance/e-moisture/e1-surface-
water/asvm/e1-surface-water-1st-edition-
amendment10.pdf)

1st edition, amendment 10 replacement pages
[PDF 617 KB]

(https://www.building.govt.nz/assets/Upl
surface-water-1st-edition-amendment1(

Version history
(https://www.building.govt.nz/building-code-compliance/e-moisture/e1-surface-water/acceptable-solutions-and-verification-methods)

Standards

Standards are frequently referred to in Acceptable Solutions and Verification Methods. They provide practical information and guidelines for building solutions.

Over 120 building standards used for Building Code compliance are now available for free download.

See the free standards relating to Code Clause E1
https://www.standards.govt.nz/get-standards/sponsored-standards/building-related-standards?buildingcode=E1
.

All standards, including the funded ones, can be accessed through the Standards New Zealand website
https://www.standards.govt.nz/ .

Related building products

All building products and building methods that have current CodeMark certification will be listed with their most up to date certificate in the Product Certificate Register on Te Pae.

View on Te Pae
https://tepae.building.govt.nz/public-registers/?type=CMark&search=%2Ae1%20-%20surface%20water

Related Determinations

Determinations are made by MBIE on matters of doubt or dispute to do with building work. Rulings are legally binding in relation to each case. Circumstances in one case may differ to others.

1994/008: Alterations to a bridge

22 DECEMBER 1994

(https://www.building.govt.nz/resolving-problems/resolution-options/determinations/determinations-issued/determination-1994-008)

2003/08: Purchaser disputes the code compliance certificate for a house

23 MAY 2003

N/A

(https://www.building.govt.nz/resolving-problems/resolution-options/determinations/determinations-issued/determination-2003-08)

View 1 Determination related to Surface water
(https://www.building.govt.nz/resolving-problems/resolution-options/determinations/determinations-issued?bcc%5B%5D=e1-surface-water&action_doSearch=Search#results)

This information is published by the Ministry of Business, Innovation and Employment's Chief Executive. It is a general guide only and, if used, does not relieve any person of the obligation to consider any matter to which the information relates according to the circumstances of the particular case. Expert advice may be required in specific circumstances. Where this information relates to assisting people:

- with compliance with the Building Act, it is published under section 175 of the Building Act
- with a Weathertight Services claim, it is published under section 12 of the Weathertight Homes Resolution Services Act 2006.